Road Network & Traffic Intelligence Guide

Using live location services for road operations questions · Knowledge base v1.0

1. What the tools provide

• **Geocoding** — resolve place names and addresses to coordinates (and back). Always resolve before routing.

• **Routing** — A→B and multi-stop routes with live-traffic travel times; reachable-range for coverage questions.

• **Traffic** — live incidents (accidents, closures, congestion, roadworks) in a bounding area.

• **POI search** — fuel, charging, hospitals, and other categories near a point or along a corridor.

• **Maps** — static images or interactive map specs with markers, routes, and incident overlays.

2. Standard analysis patterns

Question	Pattern
“How long is the drive now?”	Geocode both ends → route with live traffic → report time, distance, and delay vs free flow.
“What's happening on corridor X?”	Geocode the corridor extent → traffic incidents in that box → classify by severity → map with incidents.
“Where can we reach in 15 minutes?”	Geocode the depot → reachable range (time budget) → overlay with the facilities of interest.
“Best order for these 6 site visits?”	Geocode all stops → waypoint routing → report ordered stops with leg times.

3. Reporting conventions

• Metric units; travel times in minutes, rounded to the nearest minute; distances to 0.1 km.

• Always state the departure-time assumption ('now' vs a given time) — congestion changes the answer.

• Quote delays as 'X min over free flow' so severity is comparable across corridors.

• Coordinates are reported to 5 decimal places when precision matters (≈1 m).

4. Data caveats

Live travel times are estimates from probe data and can lag sudden events by several minutes. Incident feeds may briefly retain cleared events. For before/after studies, compare identical weekdays and times, and exclude holidays and major-event days.